Changyu Wen

GAMEPLAY & SYSTEMS DESIGN

wen.changyu@outlook.com | github.com/Justin-Wen987
Portfolio: justin-wen987.github.io/MyPortfolio/

EDUCATION

University of Pittsburgh Graduated August 2026

Bachelor of Arts, Digital Narrative and Interactive Design
Minor: Information Science | GPA: 3.657/4.000
Honors: Magna Cum Laude; Program Honors

Selected coursework: Game Design; User-Centered Design; Human-Centered Systems.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Peter Pan

October-December 2025

Boss Encounter Designer & Developer | Two-person team | Unity, C#
Source code

- Designed and built a 2D platform game boss encounter where players dodge projectiles and carry fairy dust to rescue Wendy without attacking the boss.
- Added spread and homing projectiles after classroom playtests found the initial single-shot pattern too easy.
- In later classroom playtests, players looked for gaps between shots and said the revised encounter was more fun and the difficulty felt right.

Forgotten Things

January-April 2026

Individual Project | Game & Input Design | HTML, CSS, JavaScript
Play prototype | Source code

- Designed a rhythm game prototype to test combined mouse and keyboard controls, with timing feedback, scoring, combos and adjustable note speed.
- After a player struggled with the mixed inputs, switched to a seven-key layout based on existing rhythm games. Each lane uses one key and tap notes.
- Retested with the same player, who could use the revised controls without a detailed explanation.

PomoPet

March-April 2026

Individual Project | Reward Systems & UI Design | HTML, CSS, JavaScript
Play prototype | Source code

- Wrote the design document before building a Pomodoro timer and to-do tool. Completing tasks or focus cycles earns tokens for drawing pets.
- Set pet rarity probabilities and designed a recycling loop that turns unwanted pets into coins used to buy more draw tokens.
- Defined interface requirements and refined the pet-draw animation through repeated revisions, specifying how pet images scroll sideways, slow down and stop.

SKILLS

Design: Boss encounters, control iteration, difficulty tuning, reward systems, playtesting and design documentation.

Tools used: Unity, C#, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, GitHub and GitHub Pages.